

Charter Township of Haring

Cadillac, Michigan 49601

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August 21, 1989

Mr. Dan O'Riordan, 5PA-14
Community Relations Coordinator
U.S. EPA Office of Public Affairs
230 South Dearborn Street
Chicago, Illinois 60604

Re: Cleanup Action -- Kysor of Cadillac, Inc. and Northernair Plating
Cadillac, Michigan

Dear Mr. O'Riordan:

This letter is a follow-up to my appearance during the Public Meeting which was conducted August 7, 1989 in the Wexford County Court House, Cadillac, Michigan, with respect to the Cadillac Area Ground Water Contamination Cleanup Proposals.

I appreciated the initial presentation during the meeting and thought the format was well deserving of merit. Those on the panel were well-prepared, and their presentations were concise and very understandable. I also appreciated receiving by mail in advance of the meeting the eight pages of information to allow for a preliminary briefing for the meeting.

I hope you realize that because of the complexity of issues such as this one, and at times a feeling of being so helpless, one finds oneself being very reliant on your expertise and on the inherent responsibility of various governmental departments, positions and personnel. My comments are going to be made in a general sense and not highly technical.

QUESTIONS:

1) Re: Cogeneration Michigan, Inc.

If the Cogeneration Michigan, Inc. proposal is considered as an alternative, how would the contaminated soils be remedied? It seems that their presentation only addressed the groundwater cleanup?

Isn't the extraction of 5,000 gallons of groundwater per minute an excessive amount? Will the shallow surface wells in the area be able to sustain such a draw; is there a possibility of those wells drying up? If that were to happen, where would the burden of proof lie? What recourse would there be for those impacted?

How much discharge water will result? Understanding that the discharge water will be 'salt-water', what can be done with it? Surely, it can't be discharged into the Clam River, can it?

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Mr. Dan O'Riordan
Page 2
August 21, 1989

2) Will there be an environmental impact study developed addressing some of my questions and other's concerns.

Would such a study be available for our perusal? If so, how do we acquire a copy?

QUESTIONS - Unrelated to the cleanup, but your response appreciated.

1) If the Cogeneration Michigan, Inc. proposal is NOT accepted as a cleanup alternative, would there be an Environmental Impact Study developed with respect to the facility and as it utilizes other wells; as it discharges; and as it uses our timbers, etc?

2) Can an Environmental Impact Study be requested to be developed? Who do we ask? Where do we turn?

3) Again, I ask similarly as previously written -- re: the water draw on shallow surface wells and the possibility of drying them up; the burden of proof and recourse for those impacted.

COMMENTS:

Even though your current-proposed-preferred-plan calls for a 64-year cleanup time-frame for the groundwater, and a possibly high dollar price, please DO NOT be persuaded by a shorter length of time and fewer dollars for that cleanup if the results would be a greater harm to the environment and our next generation of peoples. I know I will not live long enough to see the 64 years lapse, but let's hope that the decisions which are made about this issue will result in a quality of life which is better than today for our children and grandchildren.

Thank you for the opportunity to speak. If you have any questions, please feel free to contact me.

I do not envy the decisions you must make. A sincere thank you to all who have been and are still involved with this project.

Very truly yours,

Mary F. Stark

Mary F. Stark
Supervisor

cc: Andrea Hofstra, Township Clerk